

aign Tag be created in NetSuite > Navan can be found here. Additional information regarding travel can be found here.

<i class="fas fa-forward fa-fw color-orange font-awesome"></i> Marketing Rapid Response Process

Summary

There are times when a rapid response is needed to address industry changes, competitive moves, news about the company, and other opportunities to provide comment or thought leadership. In order to effectively respond, GitLab marketing needs to monitor, create and publish quickly. Additionally, GitLab marketing needs to support GitLab executives with content, data and soundbytes for interviews, blog-posts, etc.

Process

If a rapid response opportunity arises, please alert the head of corporate communications (or CMO if head of corporate communications is unavailable) via slack or text message. Rapid response collaboration will happen in either the competition channel (if it is competitive) or in the external-comms channel (if it is about other news). The head of corporate communications will propose a recommendation on how to best proceed with an external company message and recruit the resources to accomplish the plan (this becomes the 1 priority for each resource, unless physically impossible or their manager provides a replacement). A template for a rapid response can be found here.

The head of corporate communications will assess the rapid response request within 1 HOUR (9amEST-6pmPST). Urgency will be assessed and will be determined to be 3 HOURS (ASAP) or 24 HOURS turnaround, and the action plan will be scoped accordingly - with a bias towards releasing an MVC as soon as possible, and iterating as more news becomes available. Any disagreements on urgency or action will be escalated immediately to the CMO for a final decision.

While each response will be a custom plan, the rapid response team will leverage appropriate resources to execute on the agreed upon plan:

PMM/TMMs responsible for technical and product content and industry expertise and context
Content/Social responsible for writing and publishing

Web team responsible for any non-blog web page changes needed

Community responsible for monitoring and responding in public channels

Please have the author of the statement/blog post comment with their approval on the MR before merging, even if you have received approval in other, non-public channels.

<i class="fas fa-bookmark color-orange font-awesome"></i> Resources

Marketing Agency and Partner List

GitLab's Marketing team maintains a list of agency and partner firms in a protected Google Sheet (only accessible to GitLab team members).

The purpose of this list is to provide transparency to GitLab team members on agencies and partners onboarded to work with us. If you are considering an agency or partner to scale your team and create additional resource leverage, check this list first. If you have onboarded a new partner or agency, please add them to this list for others to view. We create added efficiency by sharing our recommended partners internally.

Sales & Marketing Localization Roadmap

In order to focus our efforts around investments the company should make per country, worldwide, it was important that sales and marketing leadership agreed to countries to prioritize (P0, P1, P2, P3 and P4).

The investment checklist at each priority level is a wishlist of how we are aiming to localize in those areas. For example, in market sales and SDR support is included in P0 as well as much higher level of translations. More details can be found internally on the tracking sheet.

Marketing Career Development

Check out the handbook page on the marketing career development program.

SECTION: marketing/performance-indicators.md

Coming in FY22: New Marketing KPIs

In Q4, we will be working through deprecating many (but not all) of the marketing KPIs below in order to move to new KPIs that we believe better map to what teams can actually impact. Here are the new KPIs, and the next step is to work with the data team to update this page.

Here is a link to a GitLab confidential Marketing Key Review deck as an example of how these KPIs will be tracked monthly.

{{% performance-indicators "marketing" %}}

Performance Indicators

1. In Contact: Defined by having 1 contact at each organization that we could reach out to - with 10k developers. See also customer lifecycle and lead and contact statuses for criteria for when we can reach out to organizations.

SECTION: marketing/plan-fy22.md

Looking for FY23?

To view the FY23 Marketing Plan, go here: <https://handbook.gitlab.com/handbook/marketing/plan->

fy23/

Overview FY22 Marketing Plan {overview}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

The purpose of this handbook page is to align our marketing team on a single FY22 marketing plan. This page and the FY22 plan are intended to be an ongoing work-in-progress, contributed to by the entire team throughout FY22 to foster collaboration and focus.

Everyone can contribute. See something you'd like to discuss or iterate on? Start an MR and tag @jgragnola, @lblanchard, or @darawarde to assist with merging!

Marketing Strategy

- Create the DevOps Platform Category
- Support sales in land and expand motion:
 - Bottoms up driving awareness in Developer and Operations professional personas
 - Tops down with purpose tops down marketing to owners of DevOps Tools, CTO, CIO, CISO, VP of Application Development
- Land and expand requires both bottoms up and tops down

Marketing Pillars

1. Elevate our brand messaging and product positioning
1. Increase Funnel Volume to drive Pipeline
1. Maintain team member delight through strong collaboration and prioritization

Goal of FY23 Marketing Plan {goal}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

Goals of FY22 Marketing Plan:

- Simplify motions and increase collaboration with the 3 GTM Motions
- Continue to drive levers identified in FY21 Project Compass, including:
 - Scale ABM Program
 - Improve Inquiry to SAO conversion rates
 - Increase Free.com and open source conversion
- Align with sales with the 4x2 segment strategies
- Build partners into our marketing motions
- Help develop marketing team-members with training and mentoring

Major market themes:

- Define and win the DevOps Platform category
- Gain CI marketshare
- Build security into our motions as a key product differentiator
- Continue driving the All-Remote work thought leadership

Timeline: Ensure marketing alignment by end of February 2021

Audience: Marketing

- Note: alignment with sales, customer success, product, etc. is occurring, but the intended audience of this HB page is Marketing

Measure: How do we confirm everyone is aligned?

- Trusted Data Sales Funnel Target vs. Actual: Trials, MQLs, SAOs, Pipeline
- Marketing Key Review Dashboard: Views, Traffic, etc.
- Demand Gen Dashboards for Campaign Metrics
- Linear Attribution Tables
- WIP: SDR Efficiency Metrics

Overview Slides of FY22 Marketing Plan

Internal only - search for GTM Slides - w Data

Sales and Marketing Alignment {sales-marketing-alignment}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

- Quarterly Epic to present a proposed set of sales plays to deliver across the 3 GTM Motions
 - PMMs list their proposed sales plays along with expected delivery dates in the Epic
 - Sales Enablement (@dcsomers @tanuja) review the proposed delivery dates and add expected dates for enablement sessions.
 - Sales Leadership (@mpyle @ronell) review the proposed plays and approve or provide input/requests on changes.
 - If plans/priorities change they will be communicated at minimum via a comment in the issue/Epic as the SSoT.
- Once agreed between sales and marketing, add campaign and enablement dates to calendar as the SSoT

TOPO Marketing Model {topo}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

The TOPO Model is the agreed upon Finance/Sales/Marketing model that drives Marketing's goals for FY22, leveraging advisory services from TOPO (now Gartner). In order to see the TOPO model please go to your Google Drive and search for FY22Mktg ModelTOPOMachado - PLAN LOCKED.

On a monthly cadence, the Marketing Key Review will be used as the venue for tracking where we are year-to-date on the agreed upon plan.

Marketing Budgets {budgets}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

All FY22 Marketing budgets are loaded into Allocadia. Please refer to the Allocadia handbook

page for more details on the tool.

Glossary of terminology {glossary}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

- **GTM Motion**: a set of sales and marketing activities and assets centered around a use case solution.
- **GTM Motion Core Team**: a group of marketers as functional DRIs for specific GTM strategies, campaigns, and aligned Sales Plays
- **Theme**: time-bound "push" in marketing calendar (example: focus on Partner Showcase in a specific month)
- **Solution GTM Strategy**: a document that describes what problem the solution solves for customers, buyer personas, messaging, positioning, and relevant competitive points. This doc is used to inform content for the Sales Play (sales audience) and the GTM Motion campaign (marketing audience).
- **Sales Play**: A repeatable set of steps a sales rep can take to drive revenue. The Sales Play document includes background information such as which company profiles and personas to target, messaging and positioning, and resources to utilize along with the specific steps to take.
- **GTM Motion Campaign**: campaign briefing document used to communicate relevant info to internal and external marketing teams to generate demand for solutions (aka GTM Motions) (aligned to sales playbooks).
- **GTM 4x2**: document used to ensure that sales and marketing are aligned on all aspects of the strategy for different market segments
- **Prescriptive Buyer Journey**: content aligned to buyer journey stages, leveraged in email nurture, digital marketing, and more
- **Project Compass**:
- **LAM**: Landed Addressable Market; annual revenue opportunity of the entirety of GitLab's market within our current customer base
- **ICP**: Ideal Customer Profile; description of our "perfect" customer company, taking into consideration firmographic, environmental and additional factors to develop our focus list of highest value accounts
- **FIT Score**: a mathematical representation of how well a prospective customer fits within your ICP (ideal customer profile)

GTM Motions {gtm-motions}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

Based on discussions with Sales and Marketing leadership, feedback from Product & Product Management leadership and by consulting industry/analyst reports, we recommend that for FY22, our major GTM motions should be focused on CI/CD, DevOps Platform, and GitOps. The overall goal of our GTM motions and sales play initiative is to improve the predictability of attaining our FY22 New and Growth AR goals, and improve our GTM efficiency (e.g. CAC, Cost per SAO/CW). We will do this by concentrating our efforts on the most important GTM motions that align to customer's main business goals/needs. where GitLab has a distinct competitive advantage and with accounts that have the highest LAM growth potential.

To view the GTM Motions Googlesheet, please go to your Google Drive and search for GTM Motions

FY22 Marketing Plan.

The GTM Motions each include a Core Team, comprised of functional DRIs for subject-matter specific teams within marketing. If your specific group is not listed as a Core Team, don't worry! Each team and each individual in Marketing plays an integral role in making the FY22 Marketing Plan a reality and a success. Please see more information in GTM Motion Core Teams and Beyond the GTM Motion Core Teams below.

All marketing team members should aim to focus ~70% of their time and plans around these GTM motions, allowing for ~30% of their time to be spent testing new messaging that's not a GTM motion.

What is included in a GTM Motion? {gtm-motion-includes}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

The list below includes potential and recommended items to include in a GTM Motion, to assist with ideation at kickoff of planning. The Core Team - in collaboration across Marketing and Sales - will determine need and timeline for the items to be included, and may add additional items for which there is an organized plan to leverage.

Potential/Recommended Pieces of a GTM Motion:

- Solution GTM Strategy Doc, including:
 - Buyer personas
 - Messaging and positioning framework
 - Market landscape
 - Product capabilities
 - etc.
- Campaign Brief(s)
- Sales Play(s)
- Supporting content
 - Buyer journey content (including awareness, consideration, and decision)
 - Competitive assets
 - Analyst relations content and activities
 - Customer references
- Alliance partner joint GTM campaigns and activities
- Channel partner campaigns
- Web ROI model
- Sales enablement

Solution GTM Strategy

The GTM Strategy doc includes the background market information to illustrate the context and personas experiencing a problem that attracts budget and describes how our solution meets that need. GTM strategy docs, also referred to as Use Case GTM pages, are kept in the handbook.

GTM Motion Campaign {gtm-motion-campaign}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

A GTM motion can include one or more marketing campaigns. GTM motion campaigns can be designed to work independently or in tandem with an associated sales play. A campaign brief describes the tactics and channels to drive demand.

May include:

- Full-funnel integrated tactics
- Cohesive design throughout touchpoints
- Virtual events (webcasts/workshops)
- Prescriptive buyer journeys
- Email nurture series
- Digital promotion (paid social, GDN, etc.)
- Organized marketing channel mix (social, PR, community)
- Integrated messaging at relevant corporate events and Commit
- Definition of ABM intent triggers
- Focus account lists (in alignment with Sales, Channel, and Alliance Partners)
- Unified L2RM (Lead to Revenue Management) reporting/analytics
- Bizible/Marketo Reporting

Sales Plays {sales-plays}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

A sales play's intended audience is sales (SAEs, SAs, CSMs, SDR as applicable) to arm the sales teams as a part of the outbound motion. In some cases, there will also be inbound marketing campaign component. The playbook prepares the sales person with both prescriptive actions to take as part of the outbound motion, as well as how to respond in the case of a supporting inbound marketing campaign.

The Sales Play should include (at minimum):

- Context (promise/offer)
- Who to meet with
- What to say
- What to show/info to use
- How to measure progress

Sales Plays should be delivered as a handbook page, or as an interactive guide leveraging PathFactory - or both.

To see the planned Sales Plays, see column C in GTM Motions.

Sales enablement to support a Sales Play and/or GTM Campaign {sales-enablement}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

The list below includes potential and recommended items to include in a Sales Play. Not all Sales Plays will include the full list, and the Core Team - in collaboration across Marketing and Sales - will determine need and timeline for the items to be included, and may add additional items for which there is an organized plan to leverage.

Potential/Recommended supporting sales enablement:

- Sales play
- Sales play training (SDR, Sales, Partners)
- ABM named accounts, Focus Account Lists
- Target personas, key contacts, prospect criteria, and other competitive and intel sources
- Campaigns related to this Sales Play
- LinkedIn InMail campaigns/templates
- Email campaigns/templates
- Outreach guide with intro messages, objection handling, differentiation
- Recommended outreach sequences
- Pathfactory tracks for sales use (or use of Pathfactory for Sales tool in SFDC)
- Video intros and other assets that can be sent by sales to prospects (referenced by sales play)
- ROI training and support, if relevant
- Sales Play specific SFDC Reporting

GTM Motion Core Teams {core-teams}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

- The Core Team's purpose is to collaborate on the research, positioning, messaging, general strategy, and overall timeline of the GTM Motion as well as related Campaigns and Sales Plays.
- The Core Teams will determine a relevant and realistic timeline in line with overarching marketing themes, and including Campaigns and Sales Plays.
- Each team member should formally commit to due dates for their work.
- Each team member is responsible for communicating as soon as possible when a due date is at risk.
- The Core Teams are comprised of functional DRIs from teams aligned to product specializations (SMEs within their teams)
- The Core Teams will kickoff together with the freedom to drive their GTM Motions as desired and with a strong team-oriented approach
- The Core Teams will ensure nothing happens in a vacuum, by proactively integrating corresponding activities across marketing, and including those beyond the core team for input
- The Core Teams are responsible for clearly communicating plans to all of Marketing (also see Core Team communication)

Roles & Responsibilities {roles-responsibilities}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

- Team Captain: Scrum Leader for the team Responsible for project planning and backlog refinement. Provides updates and participates in the scrum of scrums. Responsible for ensuring that due dates and timelines are defined and committed to by team members performing the work.
- Product Marketing: Responsible for the Solution GTM Strategy including narrative, messaging, and positioning. DRI for sales plays. Marketing DRI for Sales and SDR enablement . DRI for buyer and influencer personas. Responsible for fostering participation of the entire team in the research, positioning, messaging, general strategy.
- Marketing Campaigns: DRI for marketing campaigns, both for overall GTM motions and campaigns

related to Sales Plays. Responsible for the production of lead generation campaigns and rallying relevant teams and team members to deliver integrated marketing plans.

- Technical Marketing: Responsible for technical narrative and value proposition. DRI for practitioner personas. DRI for Customers Success enablement including SAs, CSMs, and Support. Responsible for technical content production such as demos, blogs, workshops, webinars, etc.
- Content Marketing: Responsible for content strategy and production related to the GTM motions and collaborating with other teams on prescriptive buyer journeys.
- Digital Marketing: Responsible for digital strategy and defining ideal marketing channels to reach goals.
- Brand: Responsible for cohesive branded journey across all tactics and between GTM Motions.
- Field Enablement: Sales DRI for sales enablement and training, and collaborating with GTM core teams on launch timeline.
- Sales Leadership: Responsible for providing insight into the prioritization of sales plays.

Beyond the GTM Motion Core Teams {beyond-core-teams}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

All teams play an INTEGRAL role in reaching our marketing goals, regardless if they are on the Core Team or not. Differences in team alignment (i.e. to segment/region) and approaches that will span and leverage all GTM Motions, are two reasons for teams being beyond the Core Teams.

If your team or name is not listed as part of the core team, don't worry! As part of this FY22 Marketing Plan, a keen focus is alignment and ensuring everyone across marketing is connected and collaborating. If you would like to participate on a Core Team, you may do so - connect with the Core Team of interest to learn more about getting involved! Anyone joining a Core Team will be expected to be an active contributor and participant.

Core Team Communication {core-team-communication}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

How to keep all teams in the loop will be a key responsibility of the Core Teams, and planning should not happen in silos. Continual communication of plans, progress, and how to leverage the GTM Motion collateral will be a key to success in the FY22 Marketing Plan.

The teams are encouraged to contribute ideas and processes for communication here in the handbook throughout FY22.

Slack Channels {slack}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

- fy22-mktg-plan
- gtm-ci-cd
- gtm-devops-platform
- gtm-gitops

Synchronous Calls {synchronous-calls}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

While the majority of GTM Motion work will take place asynchronously, aligned to GitLab's efficiency value, there are certain calls which will take place via Zoom.

GTM Motion Kickoff Calls (in order of occurrence):

- GitOps: 2021-02-23 (7 am PT / 10 am ET / 3 pm UTC)
- DevOps Platform: 2021-02-24 (7 am PT / 10am ET / 3 pm UTC)
- CI/CD: 2021-02-24 (8:15 am PT / 11:15 am ET / 4:15 pm UTC)

Interlocked Teams {interlocked-teams}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

Interlocking the teams across marketing will help foster the most collaborative and effective results. This section outlines specific processes and concepts for the activities we drive in Marketing.

The plans should be made in a collaborative manner to address in advance potential bandwidth constraints and discuss commitment from teams.

Corporate Marketing {interlock-corporate-marketing}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

In advance of a quarter, the Corporate Team will outline for the GTM Motions an update on upcoming events, their anticipated audience, and elements of the event. This will help the GTM teams to understand opportunities available to test messaging, promote demos and content, etc.

These corporate events are high investment, and also high return, and this will show in the results of the GTM Team.

Upon communication of the events, a GTM Team will commit to the event and be responsible for supporting all requested issues.

A core need from the GTM Team is to develop IN ADVANCE a cohesive experience from the first email invitation or ad, to the final email follow up and SDR outreach.

These events are a great opportunity to test new messaging, discuss new product features and functionality, and share feedback across the teams to implement to overall marketing strategy and messaging as relevant. In some cases, we will have messaging that worked well in the past that we want to leverage again, and review and revise as needed.

Responsibilities: Product Marketing

- Write cohesive event-specific messaging and positioning across event (emails, landing pages, ads, booth, promotional assets, etc.)
- Consult on topics, content, and activities at the event to engage the right personas and segments

- example: for AWS re:Invent, PMM define the target personas, and suggest activities and topics to engage those personas
- Review email and landing page copy for technical accuracy and consistent messaging/positioning
- 60 second pitch (in collaboration with TMM)
- Recruit speakers for sponsored speaking sessions
- Outline virtual booth content
- Define survey questions, when necessary for virtual booths

Responsibilities: Campaigns Team

- Email communication and invitation strategy
- Review email communications, including invitations and follow up, for conversion best practices (subject lines, format, CTAs, design)
- Define follow up strategy via lead nurturing to heat up to MQL
- (Verticurl Agency) Tactical email setup in Marketo
- (Verticurl Agency) Tactical addition to nurture programs, until automated in revamped nurture Q3 FY22

Responsibilities: Technical Marketing

- Contribute to content to be used in virtual booth
- Define demo for booth
- 60 second pitch (in collaboration with PMM)

Responsibilities: Digital Marketing & ABM

- Digital Marketing: Digital Ads Strategy (Paid Search, Paid Social)
- ABM: Demandbase ABM targeting
 - For design issue, is that opened by ABM

Responsibilities: Brand

- Support design and collateral needs
- Confirm cohesive brand experience throughout experience (from ads, to landing pages, to emails, etc.)

Responsibilities: Content Marketing

- Write email copy, aligned to overall messaging

Responsibilities: Marketing Operations

- Advise on Marketo program type when questions arise (taking into account scoring and program progression statuses)
- List upload(s) to Marketo programs
- Confirm Last Interesting Moments trigger appropriately, and leads increase in score based on automated scoring model
- (Verticurl Agency) Tactical setup of Marketo program and Salesforce
- Setting up Drift chatbot and tracking to set meetings in advance

- In-booth meeting setting processes
- Landing page setup (or digital experience?)
 - updated process needs to be defined

GTM 4x2 - Strategy by Sales Segment {gtm-4x2}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

The 4X2 goes into detail about differences in go-to-market by sales segment (Large, Mid-Market, SMB, and PubSec). The 4x2 includes overall business flows, new business motion overview, key measurements, and team-specific roles in the segment-specific GTM strategies.

To view the GTM 4x2 GoogleSheet, please go to your Google Drive and search for GTM Motion Strategy Template (4x2).

<!-- Need more background here -->

Themes {themes}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

Themes will help us build a more cohesive story-telling approach, leveraging the GTM Motions and unifying our activities and messaging. Pulling together collective brainpower across the marketing teams and highlighting opportunities to leverage each team's plans and ideas will help to define our FY22 themes.

Themes are expected to be generated through the Core Team planning in kicking off the GTM Motions (all teams are welcome and encouraged to contribute to theme generation!)

For example, if we want to celebrate our alliance partners in a specific month, we can identify that as a theme and determine how all teams can contribute to the plan and deliver a cohesive and organized approach.

Project Compass {project-compass}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

The Marketing Team OKRs should align to the initiatives in Project Compass.

To view the Project Compass GoogleSheet, please go to your Google Drive and search for Project Compass: Implementation - Sales & Marketing Levers.

Marketing Focus in Project Compass:

- Improve SEO through content mktg. and website improvements
- Scale ABM program to include more enterprise accounts
- Expand email marketing campaigns
- Engage referral partners to drive web traffic (e.g., Stack Overflow)
- Improve inquiry to SAO conversion reducing drop-offs (Specifically, MQL to SAO conversion)

SSoT All-Marketing Calendar {marketing-calendar}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

In kicking off FY22, let's work together to create a single all-marketing calendar where everyone can contribute, and we can answer key questions (using filters) related to upcoming marketing plans. The calendar also lives at the top of the Marketing Handbook Page.

Mockup of All-Marketing Calendar {marketing-calendar-mockup}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

In the future, the goal is to visualize these inputs in a calendar format with filters (based on columns in the doc) to allow the team to see the plans in Sisense. View the Basic Mockup in FigJam!

Currently, the GoogleDoc has pre-set filter views to help you see plans by Region, Segment, etc. to be added by team members for their respective activities.

[Link to FigJam >](#)

Inputs to All-Marketing Calendar {marketing-calendar-inputs}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

Location for inputs: In your Google Drive, search for (and bookmark) FY22 All-Marketing Calendar SSoT.

This is where all teams will input and categorize planned activities, content production, themes, and more - with filters that align to key pieces of information (GTM Motions, Alliance Partners, Sales Segments, Regions, Funnel Stage, Language, and more). This will be iterative and everyone should feel open to share their feedback and ideas - comment in the issue to share your thoughts!

Team-specific commentary on the GTM Motions {team-commentary}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

Team leaders and team members should feel empowered to add to this section, providing examples and thoughts for colleagues. Use the code below to start your section and designate a clean anchor for the section.

markdown

Team Name {commentary-team-name}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

Field Marketing {commentary-field-marketing}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

As a Field Marketer, you will be leveraging the GTM Motions in your regional strategy and plans. You may determine that a certain GTM Motion will be more heavily leveraged in your region and/or help you reach your regional goals, and you are interested in joining the Core Team for that GTM Motion. Or perhaps you have a particular passion for a specific GTM Motion and want to be an active participant and contributor to the Core Team or a specific Sales Play. Great! Connect with the Core Team to get involved.

You do not have to use all GTM Motions and you may go outside of these GTM Motions, although, as mentioned in the GTM Motions section, ~70% of your time should be spent focusing on the GTM Motions.

While the majority of Field Marketing activities should be focused on middle of the funnel activities (i.e. grabbing the leads from our focus account list (4300/4000) that are already in our system & pulling them through to SAO), there may be times where there is a gap in the focus account MQLs and Field Marketing will need to run a top of funnel campaign with the main goal being SAOs that support the Field Marketing FY22 goals. When Field Marketers run top of the funnel campaigns, they need to be sure to collaborate with the campaign manager aligned to their segment. This should be done to ensure there is alignment and that there is no overlap in team plans. This can be done in the bi-weekly FMM/MCM meetings that take place. There is not a formal approval process that the Field Marketer needs to go through with the campaigns team. There is much power in the teams working together and we already seeing the success of this happening!

Campaigns Team {commentary-campaigns-team}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

As a Campaign Manager, you have a challenge on your plate: to plan and report from the perspective of GMT Motions, AND to plan/report from the perspective of your segment/region to ensure lead flow aligned to sales targets is on track. You will be an active contributor to a Core Team by sharing insight into existing data from the GTM Motions to-date; organizing and communicating existing buyer journeys, content, and nurture emails; and strategizing/communicating top funnel activities for FY22.

You will be expected to become a subject matter expert of the GTM Motion as a Core Team member and ensure the Demand Generation team is up-to-date with what is planned for the GTM Motion (so that team members can best leverage the GTM Motions within their top-funnel campaign plans by segment/region).

Project Management {project-management}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

The GTM Motions will each have an epic, where all teams can reference plans and the issues (i.e. action items) to accomplish the plans. We will be making use of 2 week milestones (Marketing - 2021-MM-DD) as well as GTM Motion labels for each team. The teams themselves will decide how often to have stand-ups, whether live or through slack, as well as any other synchronous calls.

- The "Scrum of Scrums" kanban issue board is based on the GTM Motion labels and can be found

at the gitlab.com level under GTM Motions FY22

- Main Epic: <https://gitlab.com/groups/gitlab-com/marketing/-/epics/1785>
- CI/CD Epic: <https://gitlab.com/groups/gitlab-com/marketing/-/epics/1821>
- DevOps Platform Epic: <https://gitlab.com/groups/gitlab-com/marketing/-/epics/1822>
- GitOps Epic: <https://gitlab.com/groups/gitlab-com/marketing/-/epics/1823>

SECTION: marketing/plan-fy23.md

FY23 Marketing GTM Overview {overview}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

The purpose of this handbook page is to align our marketing team on a single FY23 marketing plan, and to communicate our FY23 approach to Sales and beyond. This page and the FY23 plan are intended to be an ongoing work-in-progress, contributed to by the entire team throughout the year to foster collaboration and focus.

Everyone can contribute. See something you'd like to discuss or iterate on? Start an MR and share it in the marketing slack channel. Tag @jgragnola and @lblanchard for assistance with merging if you do not have access!

Marketing Objectives {objectives}

1. Build category leadership for the DevOps Platform
1. Deliver first order pipeline (volume and LAM)
1. Increase user engagement
1. Increase team member community and sense of belonging

To view Overview Slides (Internal only), search your Google Drive for Marketing Strategy FY23.

Marketing Goals {goals}

1. Simplify motions and increase collaboration with our solution based marketing positioning
1. Continue to drive levers identified in Project Raptor, including:
 - Prioritize Inbound Inquiries
 - Target Strategic Accounts
 - Specialize Inbound and Outbound
 - Work on category creation
1. Also focus on FY22 areas of improvement:
 - Improve Inquiry to SAO conversion rates
 - Increase Free.com and open source conversion
 - Scale ABM process
1. Align with sales on core GTM motions
1. Build partners into our marketing motions
1. Help develop marketing team-members with training and mentoring

Timeline: Ensure marketing alignment by end of February 2022

Tracking Performance {performance}

On a monthly cadence, the Marketing Key Review will be used as the venue for tracking where we are year-to-date on the agreed upon plan.

Roles & Responsibilities {roles-responsibilities}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

See roles and responsibilities section on the campaigns handbook

Glossary of terminology {glossary}

- GTM Motion: a set of sales and marketing activities and assets centered around a solution.
- Campaign Core Team: a group of marketers as functional DRIs for specific campaigns, led by marketing campaigns
- Integrated Campaign: managed by Campaign Managers, these are global campaigns that are leveraged across marketing and sales to drive pipeline.
- Key Account Lists): key accounts determined by sales that will be a focus for integrated ABM campaigns.
- LAM: Landed Addressable Market; annual revenue opportunity of the entirety of GitLab's market within our current customer base
- ICP: Ideal Customer Profile; description of our "perfect" customer company, taking into consideration firmographic, environmental and additional factors to develop our focus list of highest value accounts

GTM Motions & Campaigns {gtm-motions}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

In FY23, we will introduce new solution-focused campaigns aimed at the executive level persona, while continuing our existing capabilities-focused campaign approach for the individual contributor level persona.

We will continue our always-on and continually-optimized capabilities-focused campaigns with a deep focus on DevOps Platform. CI/CD, GitOps, and DevSecOps are capabilities-focused campaigns that will also be continued, in addition to our compete campaigns.

To view a diagram of Business Initiatives > Solutions > Capabilities, go to your Google Drive and search Maturity Model. This is only accessible by GitLab team members. This is owned and managed by Portfolio Marketing. If you have questions about the maturity model, please direct them to the portfolio-marketing slack channel.

View this Figjam for a visual of our campaigns and how they lead to activation strategies by segment/geo. These are owned by Marketing Campaigns. If you have any questions, please direct them to the marketing-campaigns slack channel.

Campaign Core Teams & Campaign Bundles {campaign-core-teams}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

A campaign core team is comprised of teams across marketing and revenue programs, working together to build new campaigns and optimize ongoing campaigns. [Learn more here >>](#)

When a new campaign is being developed, the campaign core team will work together to develop a campaign bundle, which is then leveraged by all teams across marketing and sales for a cohesive approach from top funnel tactics to sales conversations. [Learn more here >>](#)

Value Plays {value-plays}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

A value play's intended audience is sales (SAEs, SAs, CSMs, SDR as applicable) to arm the sales teams as a part of the outbound motion. In some cases, there will also be inbound marketing campaign component. The playbook prepares the sales person with both prescriptive actions to take as part of the outbound motion, as well as how to respond in the case of a supporting inbound marketing campaign.

Note: this section to be updated in conversation with Allison Gleisner, or point instead to her updated handbook page(s).

The Value Play should include (at minimum):

- Context (promise/offer)
- Who to meet with
- What to say
- What to show/info to use
- How to measure progress

Beyond the GTM Motion Core Teams {beyond-core-teams}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

All teams play an INTEGRAL role in reaching our marketing goals, regardless if they are on the Core Team or not. Differences in team alignment (i.e. to segment/region) and approaches that will span and leverage all GTM Motions, are two reasons for teams being beyond the Core Teams.

If your team or name is not listed as part of the core team, don't worry! As part of this FY22 Marketing Plan, a keen focus is alignment and ensuring everyone across marketing is connected and collaborating. If you would like to participate on a Core Team, you may do so - connect with the Core Team of interest to learn more about getting involved! Anyone joining a Core Team will be expected to be an active contributor and participant.

Slack Channels {slack}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

- marketing
- gtm-ci-cd

- gtm-devops-platform
- gtm-gitops
- gtm-devsecops
- gtm-autosd

SSoT All-Marketing Calendar {marketing-calendar}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

The following is a single all-marketing calendar where everyone can contribute, and we can answer key questions (using filters) related to upcoming marketing plans. The calendar also lives at the top of the Marketing Handbook Page.

In your Google Drive, search for (and bookmark) FY23 All-Marketing Calendar SSoT.

This is where all teams will input and categorize planned activities, content production, themes, and more - with filters that align to key pieces of information (GTM Motions, Alliance Partners, Sales Segments, Regions, Funnel Stage, Language, and more).

Project Management {project-management}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

Each GTM campaign will each have an epic, where all teams can reference plans and the issues (i.e. action items) to accomplish the plans. We will be making use of 2 week milestones (Marketing - 2022-MM-DD). The Campaign Core Teams themselves will decide how often to have stand-ups, whether live or through slack, as well as any other synchronous calls. See more on the Campaigns handbook page >>

SECTION: marketing/positioning-faq.md

What is GitLab?

1. GitLab is an open-source, complete DevOps platform, delivered as a single application, fundamentally changing the way Development, Security, and Ops teams collaborate. GitLab is a tool that enables project planning and issue management, collaborative source code management, security scanning, continuous integration and continuous delivery, and production monitoring.

1. We have a few different versions of GitLab.

- GitLab.com. Hosted, open source for private repos. Just signup and get started.
- GitLab CE. On-premises, self-managed GitLab with LDAP integration, issue tracker, webhooks, and integrated CI.
- GitLab EE. GitLab Enterprise Edition builds on top of the Community Edition and includes extra features mainly aimed at organizations with more than 100 users. It has LDAP group sync, audit logs and multiple roles. It includes deeper authentication and authorization integration, has fine-grained workflow management, has extra server management options and it integrates with your tool stack.

- Know the comparison charts
- Overview of feature availability by version

- GitLab.com comparison by tier
- GitLab self-managed comparison by tier

What is the benefit of using GitLab?

GitLab helps organizations deliver better products faster, increase operational efficiencies, and reduce security and compliance risks. A single application that provides capabilities across DevSecOps lifecycle, GitLab reduces friction through collaboration at the point of code change. GitLab streamlines application delivery with an out of the box delivery toolchain which reduces complexity, lowers maintenance cost, and streamlines delivery. Without GitLab teams need multiple tools which they then must integrate, manage, and maintain. With GitLab, you gain visibility on how long each part of the software development lifecycle is taking and how you can improve it.

Is it similar to GitHub?

GitLab started as an open source alternative to GitHub. Instead of focusing on hosting open source projects we focused on the needs of the enterprise and now we address the challenges of the entire DevOps lifecycle, including continuous integration, continuous delivery, monitoring, and application security testing.

I use GitHub. What can GitLab offer me?

1. GitHub has done a lot for the Git space. Great company.
1. For the basic source control management, we have some key differences:
 - Scales better with multiple application servers
 - Run GitLab in a cluster
 - Multiple authentication levels
 - Group level milestones
 - 4 times more cost effective
 - Active community of 2,200+ contributors to updates that are released every month
1. So if you just want SCM, why not go with the open source edition of GitLab?
1. For the entire software development lifecycle, see GitHub vs. GitLab

Our company uses GitHub.com for all open source projects

Why should we use GitLab Enterprise Edition on-premises and not GitHub Enterprise?

1. GitHub is closed source software primarily used to publish open source software. GitLab is an open source DevOps platform primarily used to reduce the cycle time of closed source software (i.e. your company's software).
1. With GitLab Enterprise Edition you can use Repository Mirroring to mirror your open source projects from GitHub.com to your on premises GitLab server. Alternatively, if you want to have a public mirror of your GitLab project, you can now do so effortlessly using mirroring. GitHub Enterprise does not have mirroring.
1. Open source projects have different needs than projects developed on-premises by organizations. GitLab was built specifically for use by organizations on-premises and so has more features specific to the enterprise such as 5 levels of permissions, and the ability to install on a variety of operating systems.
1. Unlike other Git management solutions which can have different project views etc, GitHub and

GitLab are very similar in features and functionality as well as the workflow they support. Their URL's and API's are also similar, so developers will quickly become familiar with GitLab.

GitLab is winning enterprise

1. TLDR- Yes.

1. GitLab is used by over 100,000 organizations worldwide, on their own servers.

1. GitLab.com serves millions of projects and hundreds of thousands of users each month

1. Goldman Sachs | Problem: Needed to increase developer efficiency and software quality | Result: Improved 2 builds/day to over a 1000/day; simplified workflow and simplified administration

1. Jaguar Land Rover | Problem: Slow delivery and release cycles taking 4 to 6 weeks leading to infrequent feedback for developers| Result: Increased delivery speed from 3-6 weeks to 30 minutes giving teams faster feedback.

1. Hemmersbach | Problem: Multiple tools and communication inefficiencies slowed application delivery | Result: Increased build speed by 59x; 14.4% improvement in cycle time

1. 2019 Gartner Peer Insights Customers' Choice - Enterprise Agile Planning Tools average 4.6 rating: "DevOps without the overhead", "Simple, Intuitive and efficient DevOps Life Cycle tool", and "Secure and Scalable Solution"

1. Forrester: Q3 2017 Continuous Integration Wave-Leader

1. Gartner: 2021 Enterprise Agile Planning Tools - Visionary

1. Gartner: Q2 2020 Continuous Delivery and Release Automation-Contender

1. Forrester: 2018 New Wave Value Stream Management- Strong Performer

I use Bitbucket. What can GitLab offer me?

1. Bitbucket has done a lot for the enterprise Git space. Great company.

1. GitLab gives a choice of hosting options for free - SaaS and self-managed

1. So if you just want Source Code Management (SCM), why not go with the open source edition of GitLab?

1. Backed by a community of a few hundred thousand developers and more than 2,000 contributors.

1. We launch new features monthly and are iterating on our product faster than anyone in the market. Thanks to our community and our open-way of working, we've been able to release new features quickly and effectively.

- Job's blog post on the topic is a great read

I use or am looking at software tools like VersionOne and Rally; how does GitLab compare?

1. Both VersionOne and Rally are strong on the project management side and include road mapping, backlog management, and release management - especially when scaling to teams. GitLab provides strong collaboration across detailed issue management, task assignment, version control, repo management, code review, CI/CD, deploy and resource monitoring. For the enterprise, both tool sets fulfill an important role.

1. If you are working with a Conversational/Agile development style, GitLab EE Premium will solve your needs. GitLab is the next-generation development toolset that covers 100% of your software development lifecycle in one unified experience.

1. If you are going down a path to SAFe, VersionOne is a great option, there is also a native integration from VersionOne with GitLab for the code repo and CI/CD.

I use or am looking at GitSwarm from Perforce

Do I need GitLab too? Am I missing anything by not working directly with GitLab?

1. GitSwarm is built on GitLab CE or EE.

1. GitSwarm combines Perforce and GitLab to give developers a Git-based workflow they prefer while also providing an organization with enterprise-class scalability, security, and file management performance from Perforce.

1. We're happy that Perforce chose GitLab to help their customers create, code, and deploy together. To learn more, have a look at the GitSwarm overview, <https://www.perforce.com/products/helix4git>.

1. How should GitLab account executives engage prospects that are currently using or evaluating GitSwarm?

- If the prospect is already using GitSwarm CE, the GitLab channel representative should work with the Perforce account executive to focus on the benefits of upgrading the customer to GitSwarm EE.

- Perforce customers can pay via a perpetual license fee up-front with an annual Support and Maintenance fee or they can purchase via an annual subscription fee.

- GitLab's new LFS feature addresses the need to provide storage for large binary files, which is a need of many Perforce clients leveraging Git. This is a must-have feature for companies in the video, hardware, and gaming space.

- GitLab has partnered with Perforce as a reseller.

- GitLab channel managers should be proactive in identifying companies that are using Perforce Helix and work with Perforce account executives in developing a plan to move them to using GitSwarm EE (or at a minimum GitSwarm CE).

- Many long-term Perforce customers are in the process of evaluating Git solutions for certain user segments within their organizations and this is good time to support Perforce in proactively building a relationship during the early evaluation stages.

We're already using GitLab CE for free. Why should we upgrade?

1. CE is a great option for smaller teams but larger organizations benefit from the features of GitLab EE.

1. GitLab Enterprise Edition builds on top of the Community Edition and includes extra features mainly aimed at organizations with more than 100 users.

1. It has LDAP group sync, audit logs and multiple roles.

1. It includes deeper authentication and authorization integration, has fine-grained workflow management, has extra server management options and it integrates with your tool stack.

1. More customizable and secure.

Who are some of your customers?

1. Used by more than 100,000 organizations.

1. Large - IBM, AT&T, CERN

1. Small - SpaceX, Stack Overflow

Why are you monetizing an open-source product?

1. Our community has worked hard on making a great product.

1. The enterprise world could benefit from this product.

1. We wanted to be able to offer some features that aren't necessarily needed in the open source world but are needed for large companies.

1. For those features, we charge our large customers and in return are able to create those features and hire people to work on the open source project.

I use the hosted version of GitLab. Why would my company need on-premises?

- 1. More flexibility and customization based on security requirements (i.e. VPCs, IDS/IPS, etc)
- 1. LDAP integration
- 1. Paid support
- 1. 2FA
- 1. Permissions management

How does support work?

- 1. For self-managed
 - 1. On-premises EE - support statement
 - 1. On-premises CE or Free - support statement
- 1. For GitLab.com
 - 1. Paid tiers - support statement
 - 1. Free plan users - support statement

Do you offer a solution for migrating data from GitHub, Bitbucket, SVN to GitLab?

- 1. Import from Bitbucket, GitHub, anywhere
- 1. Want to start using GitLab? You can easily import your repositories from Bitbucket, GitHub, Gitorious, or anywhere else, all in batch!
- 1. Migrating SVN to GitLab
 - <https://docs.gitlab.com/ee/user/project/import/index.htmlimport-from-subversion>
 - SVN stands for Subversion and is a version control system (VCS). Git is a distributed version control system.

Why aren't you using a GPL license?

- 1. Based on Ruby on Rails (RoR)
- 1. MIT license is common for Ruby and RoR

SECTION: marketing/prescriptive-buyer-journeys.md

Overview {overview}

In relation to the FY21-22 Segment Marketing Plan, the prescriptive persona-based buyer journeys is as a collaborative effort across all Marketing teams to build cohesive prescriptive persona-based buyer journeys, aligning messaging, channels, content, and offers based on the stage of the buyer journey (placement in the funnel).

Key documents {key-documents}

Epic: Prescriptive Persona-Based Buyer Journeys

Epic: Prescriptive Persona-Based Buyer Journeys

Meeting recordings {meeting-recordings}

High-Level Content Collaboration - meeting notes

Enterprise Buyers Journey Mapping (multiple sessions)

Alignment: Campaigns + Digital - meeting notes

Alignment: Campaigns + Digital + Content + PMM - meeting notes

Alignment: Campaigns + Digital + FMM + ABM - meeting notes

Alignment: Campaigns + Partner Marketing + PMM - meeting notes

Diagrams and GDocs {diagrams-docs}

Figjam: Enterprise Buyer Journey

Content slotted into Enterprise Buyer Journey - Use Cases (GDoc)

Content slotted into Enterprise Buyer Journey - Competitive (GDoc)

PF Track organization and rollout (GDoc)

How are prescriptive buyer journeys used? {how-are-they-used}

The prescriptive buyer journeys are the foundation for our demand generation strategy. We map the content offers that are most relevant to the persona based on stage in the funnel (awareness, consideration, decision/purchase). Tapping into our Marketo segmentations and building out targeting logic for our nurture engine will allow us to send the right offer to the right persona at the right time, based on their previous engagement and funnel stage.

For example, if they are at an Inquiry state (Top Funnel) and have previously engaged with CI content, they would receive consideration stage CI content to help them learn more about GitLab and progress to an MQL status, to be followed up with by SDRs.

The first iteration of building these prescriptive buyer journeys was a highly collaborative effort of mapping existing content. The process has helped to identify content gaps and reasoning for persona storyboards to dig into the perspective of the buyer, and then build content to the needs of the buyer in the given stages.

Content Mapping {content-mapping}

In today's digital-first world, customers expect flawless omnichannel experiences. From seeing an ad on their mobile phone to interacting with our website to speaking with a sales representative, we need to ensure that there is cohesion across every interaction. By creating a full-funnel content journey map, we look at the lifecycle of a customer from first interaction to closing a sale and outline the narrative we want to tell. This narrative is our blueprint for content creation and campaign planning.

Designing a full-funnel content journey enables us to serve more relevant content to our potential customers resulting in faster conversion times. Creating a repeatable process for this ensures we can quickly iterate and create new content journeys for specific personas and industries.

The following documentation covers how to design a full-funnel content journey including who is

involved and what needs to be done at each step.

This can be expanded to retention after a marketing proof of concept cycle is completed.

Sequence of Actions {sequence-of-actions}

1. Create an Epic. Provide target audience detail and campaign requirements. Include campaign strategy, channels, and any major event or news dependencies.

1. Host & record a cross-functional kick-off call to introduce the project requirements and discuss timeline. Focus the kick-off call discussion on themes and surfacing potential cross-functional alignment; set aside 30 minutes for creative brainstorming. The kick-off call should be scheduled a quarter ahead of the campaign launch date. This gives content creators time to storyboard and produce content.

1. Fill out the positioning matrix (TODO add link to tab in campaign GNATT template). Time box to seven working days.

1. Complete the storyboard. Strategic marketing writes the first draft, content marketing provides sub-edits (big picture/structural review) and feedback, strategic marketing revises, and finally, content marketing copyedits the final draft. Time box to seven working days.

1. Perform a content gap analysis to fill the storyboard with content. First, identify your "big rock" assets to be used as digital offers (eBooks, webinars, white papers, reports). Identify existing content that can be used as-is or revised for the campaign and net new content needs. Try to limit the amount of net new content per campaign. Focus on one or two impactful assets that can enjoy a long shelf life and be easily repackaged. Time box to seven working days.

1. Content pods create/repurpose/update content to fill the storyboard with content. This work will take the bulk of the quarter.

1. Create PathFactory tracks, nurture emails, and update web pages with new offers.

1. Launch the campaign.

Content Working Groups {working-groups}

A content working group is a cross-functional team aligned to messaging, content strategy, and content creation for a single campaign or event. The members of a content working group can vary based on the campaign but a standard group may include: a program manager, a subject matter expert, a content strategist, a technical expert, and a designer. More complex, web-based projects may include a UX strategist and a web developer.

Content Strategist: The content strategist is responsible for the overall content experience; they are focused on the flow and packaging of content. The content strategist is the DRI for content strategy, for final content asset output, and for finalizing content offers & tracks.

Designer: The designer is responsible for the visual experience; they are focused on the look and feel of content. The designer is the DRI for brand strategy, for creative themes, and for creative assets.

Program Manager The program manager is responsible for the overall digital experience; they are focused on the delivery and tracking of content. The program manager is the DRI for the campaign strategy, for channel distribution, and for reporting.

Product Marketer: The product marketer is responsible for the go to market strategy; they are focused on the targeting and positioning of content. The product marketer is the DRI for messaging, for content creation, and for subject matter expertise.

Technical Marketer: The technical marketer is responsible for practical application strategy;

they are focused on the technical depth and accuracy of content. The technical marketer is the DRI for practical application scenarios, for content creation, and for product education.

This list can be expanded to include brand awareness after a successful proof of concept.

Scheduling a Kick-Off Call {kickoff-call}

The Marketing Programs Manager is responsible for scheduling and leading the kick-off call. The call should be scheduled no later than 2 weeks before the start of the quarter and three months before the campaign launch date. This ensures the teams have time to review and provide feedback on the proposed requirements and audience targeting information before starting the work, and it ensures enough time for content creation.

The kick-off call should include at least one contributing representative from each team and the team leads. Marketing Program Managers are responsible for creating the agenda and preparing the following ahead of the meeting:

- Campaign brief including detailed targeting information
- Proposed project timeline including key delivery dates
- Digital journey map
- Links to storyboard and content journey workspaces

Record the call and share the recording in the marketing channel in Slack.

Identifying your Audience {audience-identification}

The storyboard template is intended to make it simple to adapt our messaging and use cases to specific audiences. Each new content journey we create should be rooted in a use case and targeted to a specific persona. We can tailor a content journey based on the following targeting information:

- Segment: What size company are targeting?
- Persona(s): Who are we talking to?
- Use Case(s): Which use cases are most relevant to this persona?
- Region: Where are we targeting? Is this a US-specific campaign or a localized campaign?

If there are multiple personas to target, the digital journey map should identify who we are speaking to per channel.

Positioning and messaging {positioning-messaging}

TODO strategic marketing fill in

Storyboarding the content journey map {storyboarding}

Through storyboarding we look at the end to end content journey and outline the story we want to tell. This narrative is our blueprint for content creation. Start by making a copy of the content journey mapping template. Write the sequence of messaging that will move the prospect across the stages of the buyer's journey. Each message should clearly state the key takeaway you want to provide.

How to use the storyboard template {storyboard-how-to}

The first step to creating a full-funnel content journey is to storyboard the narrative. The audience you are targeting is the main character of the narrative, and the content you create is the plot. Use the following story arc as a guideline for creating the narrative:

Story Arc Guide {story-arc-guide}

Stage	Problem	Plan	Success
Awareness	1. Define and describe the business problem they are facing. Help them realize that their pain is actually a problem that can be solved.	2. Their peers have successfully solved the problem - they too can have a plan. Give them hope that a solution is in reach.	3. Show them the path to overcoming the problem (process, tools, etc). They now can take action and start to address their challenge.
Consideration	4. Where should I get started solving this problem? There are so many choices.	5. How can I compare the different options. What's the best approach? Is there a best solution?	6. I need to be positive that this is the right solution / approach. Are there proof points where others like myself have overcome this problem
Purchase	7. Convince my boss (procurement, legal, etc.) of the choice.	8. Demonstrate and prove the business value of changing. ROI of investing and making a change.	9. How can I quickly get started and showcase immediate wins.

Using the template below, write down the message you want to convey at each stage of the funnel.

Each stage has three message columns. When reading across the columns a story should emerge. The last column, labeled bridge and closing message should unite the current and next stage messages. A bridge message can also be used to introduce a new use case. For example:

1. An awareness stage bridge message may show how someone can solve a problem using GitLab technology. It doesn't explicitly call out the benefits of GitLab.
2. A consideration stage bridge message may show how a customer achieved success with GitLab. It explicitly calls out the benefits of GitLab.
3. A purchase stage closing message may calculate the ROI of implementing GitLab. It explicitly demonstrates why their purchase is a good investment.

Content journey mapping: Make a copy of the content journey template. Start by matching existing content to each message in the storyboard. The key takeaway of the suggested content should match the key takeaway of the message. If not content exists, make a plan to create it.

It's critical that the message and content are tailored specifically to the target audience. Avoid diluting the message and experience by loosely fitting existing content in the journey. The content should suit the message exactly. If content does not exist, notify the Marketing Program Manager (project manager) and make a plan to create that content. This may affect the project timeline.

Performing a content gap analysis {content-gap-analysis}

The content gap analysis determines which content will be used in the campaign and guides new

content production. Missing campaign content is prioritized for production.

How to use the content journey template {content-journey-how-to}

Once you have completed the storyboard exercise, it's time to find content that maps to the story. Make a new tab in your spreadsheet so that you have the two templates side by side.

Begin by filling in each offer. Offers should be high-impact content that can be put behind a gated or form-fill. For example: eBooks, whitepapers, webinars, maturity models, analyst reports, videos, case studies. The content may or may not be gated as part of the digital experience. The content you choose for each offer should convey the message you wrote in the storyboard exercise. This may mean either altering existing or creating net new content.

Next, choose your supporting content assets. These can be any type of content and should reinforce the main message. For example, if your message is "I need to learn how to code" and the offer is an eBook on Coding 101, your supporting assets may be a blog post walking through a practical application and a video highlighting the key takeaways from the eBook.

Avoid reusing content in the same content journey.

SECTION: marketing/smb-marketing.md

Who we are

SMB Marketing addresses the SMB Segment in support of SMB Sales, Sales Development (SDR) in Marketing, Growth in Product, and other teams.

SMB Marketing Team

| PMM | Campaigns | Digital | Content | TMM | Channel | PMO |

| ---- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |

| Brian Glanz | Indre Kryzeviciene,
Shari Rances | Zac Badgley | Sharon Gaudin | William Arias | Karen Pourshadi | Kimberly Bolton |

Our DRI is Brian Glanz.

Team members are DRIs for their own tasks and report into their home teams, per GitLab's DRI culture and functional reporting lines.

How we work

Collaborate with us

SMB Marketing's GitLab project helps to manage our own issues, while we work across many teams. We dogfood GitLab to collaborate on ideas, gather feedback, and manage projects, including our use

of the Handbook.

GitLab Team Member resources

Some resources are only available to GitLab team members, like our Slack channel, call notes, or status reports.

Slack

Say hi in the SMB Marketing Slack channel.

FY23 plan and progress

This presentation documents the SMB Marketing FY23 plan and progress.

Monthly sync of SMB Sales and SMB Marketing

We share additional status reports in our monthly sync with SMB Sales, when we review deliverables and results, actuals to targets, and upcoming initiatives. Notes and recordings are open to GitLab Team Members.

Weekly status report

The SMB Marketing weekly status report is published in our team Slack channel and in this FY23 archive.

Weekly team sync

The SMB Marketing team has an optional weekly sync at 9:00 AM Pacific on Wednesdays. It's open internally.